

Award Interpretation Rulebook

Hospitality Industry (General) Award 2020

MA000009

Award	Hospitality Industry (General) Award 2020 (MA000009)
Rates effective	First full pay period on or after 1 July 2025
Version	1.0
Generated	4 June 2026
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Verified against the Fair Work Ombudsman Pay Guide MA000009 (eff. 1 July 2025) and the FWC award text.

SECTION 01**Classifications**

Every employee is mapped to one classification — Introductory or Levels 1–6 — based on the duties they actually perform, not their job title. Classification definitions live in Schedule A. Codes below combine the level with a stream tag (FB = food & beverage, K = kitchen, GS = guest service, SEC = security, SUP = supervisory).

Code	Level	Stream / role	Indicative duties & training	Schedule
INT	Introductory	All streams	Entry level on starting; induction and basic on-the-job training. Progresses to Level 1 after 3 months (or sooner if competent).	Sch A.1
L1-FB1	Level 1	Food & beverage	Food & beverage attendant grade 1 — clearing/setting tables, collecting glasses, assisting; on-the-job training.	Sch A (L1)
L1-KA1	Level 1	Kitchen	Kitchen attendant grade 1 — general cleaning, dishwashing, basic food-prep assistance.	Sch A (L1)
L1-GS1	Level 1	Guest service	Guest service grade 1 — portering, cleaning, general guest assistance.	Sch A (L1)
L2-FB2	Level 2	Food & beverage	Food & beverage attendant grade 2 — table service, taking orders, serving/selling liquor (adult rate applies, cl. 13.5).	Sch A (L2)
L2-CK1	Level 2	Kitchen	Cook grade 1 — basic cooking and food prep under supervision.	Sch A (L2)
L2-SEC	Level 2	Security	Security officer / door person — controlling entry, monitoring patrons (check cross-award MA000016).	Sch A (L2)
L3-FB3	Level 3	Food & beverage	Food & beverage attendant grade 3 — cocktails, cellar/keg work, supervising grade 1–2; Certificate III pathway.	Sch A (L3)
L3-CK2	Level 3	Kitchen	Cook grade 2 — cooking on own initiative, preparing menu items.	Sch A (L3)
L3-GS3	Level 3	Guest service	Guest service grade 3 — reception, reservations, cash handling.	Sch A (L3)
L4-SUP	Level 4	Supervisory	Food & beverage supervisor / attendant grade 4 — supervising and training staff; trade or equivalent.	Sch A (L4)
L4-CK3	Level 4	Kitchen	Cook (tradesperson) grade 3 — qualified cook, à la carte preparation.	Sch A (L4)
L5-CK4	Level 5	Kitchen	Cook grade 4 (chef de partie) — specialised cooking, supervising cooks.	Sch A (L5)
L6-CK5	Level 6	Supervisory / kitchen	Cook grade 5 (chef) / functions & catering supervisor — full control of a kitchen or function operation.	Sch A (L6)

Refs: Schedule A — Classification Definitions · cl. 13.5 (liquor service = adult rate) · See Section 11 for cross-award triggers (security, restaurants, clubs).

SECTION 02

Base Rates

Adult minimum rates as at the first full pay period on or after 1 July 2025 (2024–25 Annual Wage Review). The weekly rate is for a full-time 38-hour week; part-time employees are paid the same hourly rate pro rata. The hourly rate equals the weekly rate divided by 38.

Code	Classification	Weekly (38 hr)	Hourly
Intro	Introductory	\$922.70	\$24.28
L1	Level 1	\$948.00	\$24.95
L2	Level 2	\$982.40	\$25.85
L3	Level 3	\$1,014.70	\$26.70
L4	Level 4	\$1,068.40	\$28.12
L5	Level 5	\$1,135.50	\$29.88
L6	Level 6	\$1,165.70	\$30.68

Refs: Table 3 — Minimum rates · cl. 18.1 · Adult rates; juniors see Section 09

SECTION 03**Casual Loading**

Casual employees receive a 25% loading on the ordinary hourly rate in place of paid leave and notice.
IMPORTANT STACKING RULE: do not add the 25% loading on top of casual penalty rates — the casual Saturday/Sunday/public-holiday percentages in Section 04 ALREADY include the loading. Apply the 25% loading only to ordinary (non-penalty) hours.

Code	Classification	Ordinary hourly	+25% loading	Casual hourly
Intro	Introductory	\$24.28	\$6.07	\$30.35
L1	Level 1	\$24.95	\$6.24	\$31.19
L2	Level 2	\$25.85	\$6.46	\$32.31
L3	Level 3	\$26.70	\$6.68	\$33.38
L4	Level 4	\$28.12	\$7.03	\$35.15
L5	Level 5	\$29.88	\$7.47	\$37.35
L6	Level 6	\$30.68	\$7.67	\$38.35

Refs: cl. 11.1 (casual loading) · cl. 11.4 · Loading applies to ordinary hours only — NOT compounded onto penalty rates (see Section 04).

SECTION 04**Penalty Rates**

Penalty rates are a percentage of the ordinary hourly rate. Casual percentages are higher because they already incorporate the 25% casual loading (so the loading is never added again). Dollar examples below use a Level 3 employee (ordinary \$26.70/hr).

Day / type	FT/PT %	FT/PT \$ (L3)	Casual %	Casual \$ (L3)	Notes
Saturday	125%	\$33.38	150%	\$40.05	
Sunday	150%	\$40.05	175%	\$46.73	
Public holiday	225%	\$60.08	250%	\$66.75	Min engagement applies
Minimum engagement	—		casual 2 hrs		PT min 3 hrs; PH min per cl. 35

Refs: Table 14 — Penalty rates · cl. 29.2 · Casual % already includes the 25% loading (cl. 11.4). · Min engagement: casual cl. 11.3; public holidays cl. 35.

SECTION 05**Evening & Night**

On ordinary hours worked Monday to Friday, a flat additional amount per hour applies to evening and night work. These are flat dollars, NOT percentages, added on top of the ordinary (or casual) hourly rate. They apply Monday to Friday ONLY — on weekends and public holidays the Section 04 penalty rates already cover these periods, so the evening/night loading is not added as well.

Window	Additional loading	Days	Notes
7:00pm – midnight	+\$2.81 per hour	Mon–Fri	Added to ordinary/casual hourly rate
Midnight – 7:00am	+\$4.22 per hour	Mon–Fri	Added to ordinary/casual hourly rate
Saturday / Sunday / public holiday	Not applied	Sat–Sun, PH	Weekend/PH penalty rates already cover these hours (no stacking)

Refs: cl. 29 (evening and night work loadings) · Flat per-hour amounts, eff. 1 July 2025 · Mon–Fri only — do not stack with weekend/PH penalties.

SECTION 06**Overtime**

Overtime is triggered when an employee works beyond their ordinary-hours limits. Multipliers are of the ordinary hourly rate. Sunday and public-holiday overtime are paid at the higher flat multiplier shown (not added on top of the weekend/PH penalty).

Trigger / rate	Threshold or multiplier	Notes
Daily trigger (FT/PT)	More than 11.5 ordinary hrs/day	Hours beyond the daily ordinary maximum are overtime
Weekly trigger	More than 38 hrs/week	Averaged over the roster cycle where applicable
Casual daily trigger	More than 12 hrs/day	Casual overtime applies beyond 12 hours in a day
Overtime — first 2 hours	150%	Monday to Saturday
Overtime — after 2 hours	200%	Monday to Saturday
Overtime — Sunday	200%	All overtime worked on a Sunday
Overtime — public holiday	250%	All overtime worked on a public holiday

Refs: Table 13 — Overtime rates · cl. 28 · Ordinary-hours limits: see Section 08 (cl. 15).

SECTION 07

Allowances

Monetary allowances as at 1 July 2025 (Schedule C). All-purpose allowances are added to the minimum rate before penalties and overtime are calculated. Two items requested in the brief — a coffee/espresso-machine allowance and a cold-places allowance — do not exist under MA000009 and are shown as N/A. The award treats split and broken shifts under a single combined allowance.

Allowance	Amount	Basis	Clause
Meal allowance (overtime)	\$16.73	per occasion	cl. 26 / Sch C
Tool allowance (cooks/apprentice cooks)	\$2.03 per day, max \$9.94 per week	per day / week	cl. 26 / Sch C
Uniform / special clothing (catering)	Reimbursement of cost of special uniform/clothing	reimbursement	cl. 26 / Sch C
Laundry allowance (catering)	FT \$6.00/week; PT & casual \$2.05 per uniform laundered	per week / item	cl. 26 / Sch C
Broken shift allowance	\$3.53/day (gap 2–3 hrs); \$5.34/day (gap >3 hrs)	per day	cl. 13 / 26 / Sch C
Split shift allowance	Combined with broken-shift allowance (same amounts)	per day	cl. 13 / 26 / Sch C
Coffee / espresso machine allowance	<i>N/A — not provided under MA000009</i>	—	—
Cold places allowance	<i>N/A — not provided under MA000009</i>	—	—
First aid allowance	FT \$12.82/week; PT & casual \$2.56/day (max \$12.82/week)	per week / day	cl. 26 / Sch C
Working supervisor (in charge) — airport catering	\$0.56–\$1.46 per hour by team size (5 / 10 / 20 / 20+)	per hour	cl. 26 / Sch C
Higher duties	Paid at the higher classification rate for time worked (2+ hrs/day = full day)	classification rate	cl. 18
Travel / vehicle	Vehicle (managerial, hotels) \$0.99/km; airport-catering travel \$8.45/day	per km / day	cl. 26 / Sch C

Refs: cl. 26 — Allowances · Schedule C — Summary of Monetary Allowances · Coffee-machine & cold-places allowances are not part of MA000009.

SECTION 08**Ordinary Hours**

Ordinary hours and rostering limits under clause 15. MA000009 does not fix a single daily “span” of ordinary hours (hospitality operates across all seven days); instead it sets daily/weekly maxima and uses the time-of-day loadings in Section 05 and the weekend/public-holiday penalties in Section 04.

Rule	Value	Clause
Ordinary hours per week	38 (averaged over the cycle)	cl. 15.1
Maximum ordinary hours per day	11.5 hours (excludes meal breaks)	cl. 15.1(c)
Minimum ordinary hours per day	6 hours when rostered	cl. 15.1(c)
Days of operation	Any day Mon–Sun (evening/night & weekend loadings apply)	cl. 15 / 29
Break between shifts	Minimum 10 hours (8 hours on roster changeover)	cl. 15.5(e)
Casual minimum engagement	2 consecutive hours per occasion	cl. 11.3
Part-time minimum engagement	3 hours per shift (min 8 hrs/week)	cl. 10 / 15.2
Meal & rest breaks	Unpaid meal break for 5+ hr shifts; paid 20-min rest breaks on longer shifts	cl. 16

Refs: cl. 15 — Ordinary hours of work and rostering · cl. 16 — Breaks · No single 7am–midnight ordinary-hours span under MA000009; use the loading windows in Section 05.

SECTION 09**Junior Rates**

Junior employees (other than office employees) are paid a percentage of the adult rate for their classification, by age (Table 5). **VERRIDE:** a junior who serves or sells liquor, or who holds a trade qualification, must be paid the full adult rate for the work performed regardless of age (cl. 13.5) — in practice at least Level 2, since liquor service is a Level 2 duty.

Age	% of adult rate	Clause	Notes
Under 17 years	50%	cl. 18.4 (Table 5)	
17 years	60%	cl. 18.4 (Table 5)	
18 years	70%	cl. 18.4 (Table 5)	
19 years	85%	cl. 18.4 (Table 5)	Verified — the award uses 85% (not 90%)
20 years	100%	cl. 18.4 (Table 5)	Adult rate
Liquor service / trade-qualified junior	100% (adult)	cl. 13.5	Adult rate regardless of age; bar work is Level 2+

Refs: cl. 18.4, Table 5 — Junior rates · cl. 13.5 — liquor-service / trade-qualified juniors paid adult rate · Verified against FWO Pay Guide (eff. 1 July 2025).

SECTION 10

Decision Logic

The order of operations the interpreter follows for a single shift. Each step names the inputs it needs, the section of this rulebook to consult, the governing clause, and what it outputs to the next step.

Step	Decision	Inputs	Consult	Clause	Output
1	Identify classification	Role, duties performed	§01	Sch A	Classification level + code
2	Set base rate	Classification, employment type	§02	cl. 18.1	Ordinary hourly rate
3	Apply casual loading	Employment type (casual?)	§03	cl. 11.4	Casual ordinary rate (loading on ordinary hrs only)
4	Split ordinary vs overtime	Daily & weekly hours	§08, §06	cl. 15, 28	Ordinary-hour and overtime-hour buckets
5	Apply overtime multipliers	OT hours, day of week	§06	cl. 28	Overtime pay (150/200/250%)
6	Apply weekend / PH penalties	Day of week, employment type	§04	cl. 29.2	Penalty pay on ordinary hours
7	Apply evening / night loading	Shift times (Mon–Fri)	§05	cl. 29	Flat \$2.81 / \$4.22 per-hour additions
8	Add allowances	Shift attributes (split/broken, first aid, tools, travel)	§07	cl. 26	Allowance amounts
9	Junior adjustment & liquor override	Age, liquor-service duties	§09	cl. 18.4, 13.5	Final rate + total pay with cited clauses

Refs: Run steps in order; later steps depend on earlier outputs. · Casual loading (step 3) is never compounded onto penalties (step 6).

SECTION 11

Cross-Award Triggers

Patterns in the timesheet or role data that suggest another modern award may be the correct (or primary) award. These are flags for human review — do NOT split a single employee across two awards automatically.

Pattern observed	Candidate award	Code	Reason for flag	Action
Standalone security / crowd control, no food & beverage duties	Security Services Industry Award	MA000016	Primary duties are security, not hospitality	Confirm primary award
Restaurant-only venue, no bar or accommodation	Restaurant Industry Award	MA000119	Business may be a restaurant, not a hotel/pub	Confirm coverage
Quick-service / takeaway food, minimal table service	Fast Food Industry Award	MA000003	Operation resembles fast food	Confirm coverage
Employer is a registered or licensed club	Registered & Licensed Clubs Award	MA000058	Club employees may be covered by the Clubs Award	Confirm employer type
Predominantly clerical / reception / back-office	Clerks—Private Sector Award	MA000002	Clerical work may fall under the Clerks Award	Confirm role coverage

Refs: Cross-award checks are advisory flags for review. · cl. 4 — Coverage · Never auto-split one employee across awards.

Disclaimer

This rulebook is an interpretation aid prepared by Axi-WFM to support payroll decisions. It is a plain-English summary of the Hospitality Industry (General) Award 2020 (MA000009) and is NOT the award itself, nor legal advice. Rates and rules were verified against the Fair Work Ombudsman Pay Guide for MA000009 effective from the first full pay period on or after 1 July 2025. Awards are varied regularly (at minimum each Annual Wage Review on 1 July). Always confirm the current figure against the award text and Pay Guide at [fairwork.gov.au](https://www.fairwork.gov.au) before relying on it. Where this brief differed from the published award, the verified award figure has been used and noted.